

1 Quiet Heritage Paragpur

This is India's only officially declared heritage hamlet and deservedly so. Located in the lush Kangra Valley in Himachal and framed by the snow-tipped Dhauladhar mountain range. Paragpur's centuries-old dwellings and cobbled streets evoke its fairy-tale past revolving around Pragma Devi, a warrior queen. Adding to its mystique is the Judge's Court, a 1914-vintage country estate of Justice Sir Jai Lal. His descendants now manage the estate. The European-style, double-storey mansion is a refreshingly quiet resort.



3 Silent Space 360° Leti

360° Leti is remote, cut off from noise, pollution and the chaos of urban living. Cellphones and the Internet don't work here. The uber-luxurious private glass cottage near Almora comes at a steep price of Rs 1 lakh per person for a three-day stay, but it includes a private slice of Uttarakhand, complete with silver-service dining and French wines, a 360-degree view of the Himalayas, and the terrace gardens of Kumaon.

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new travel destinations

A heritage hamlet in the Kangra Valley. The historic ruins of Hampi. An emerald atoll in the Lakshadweep Islands. The second coldest inhabited place after Siberia. Ten getaways that get away from the beaten track.

2 Cool Comfort Drass

Peace-time Drass is a stunning sight with its sylvan, almost surreal landscape of lush meadows and the starkly barren Himalayas. As the second coldest inhabited place after Siberia, Drass has challenging treks through the moonscape-like Zaskar Valley and rafting in the ferocious Indus river.

4 Hidden Curio Chettinadu

It's still hidden away, but the charms of the Chettinadu region lie in its shops of antique wooden furniture with inlaid tiles and glass work, old statues and curios. Many of the mansions have been converted into homestays and heritage hotels. Home to the erstwhile Nattukottai Chettians, Chettinadu is famed for its culinary delicacies like chicken chettinad, *nandu* (crab), roast rabbit and quail.

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5 Free Falling Athirapally

There's more to God's own country than just the sun and the sea. About 80 km from Cochin in Trichur district are the Athirapally waterfalls in hilly rain forests—and it's as wild and beautiful as it can get. The waterfall along with its sister, the spectacular Vazhachal, drop from misty mountains and merge with the Chalakudy river.